

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Sue Venir

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Sue Venir

Cultural Property Attorney

Sue corrects the fine print on dinner menus. Sue is the lawyer museums call when an object has three owners, four countries, six contradictory export documents, and one increasingly angry newspaper.

- Works with **Artie Ficial** and **Monet Bags** on museum contracts.
- Has argued opposite sides of restitution cases with **Mona Lott**. They're ruthless opponents but still besties.
- **Dr. Art E. Fact** supplies expert opinions for Sue's cases. Sue usually asks for a shorter version.

ACTING TIPS

A lawyer with sass: precise, formidable, patient, amused by sloppy certainty. Ask pointed questions and answer only the question actually asked.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Sue Venir. Lovely to meet you. Nothing I say over dinner constitutes legal advice, although I will be keeping notes.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Sue Venir

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

You wrote a private legal memorandum concluding that the Star Bowl's acquisition was too risky to defend confidently. Grant forced you to replace it with a softer opinion and planned to cite your name during the announcement.

Your other secret

Both versions of the memo still exist. You kept the original instead of destroying it, which could expose you to professional embarrassment and Grant to serious scrutiny.

Conversations to start

- Learn whether Mona Lott has obtained a copy of your original memo.
- Keep Dr. Art E. Fact from publicly speculating about your legal advice.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1** *Open the cupboard where ordinary things have been given a private gallery.*
- 2** *Look above the large door that admits the household vehicles.*
- 3** *Find a chair that a magnet might fancy. Look beneath its seat.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Sue Venir

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I supplied the softer opinion Grant demanded. I also retained my original memorandum. It says permanent possession does not cure disputed title. He intended to quote my convenient version and ignore the original. Both bear my signature. I am perfectly capable of explaining a compromised opinion without consenting to a fraudulent announcement.

IF MURDERER

Grant forced a softer opinion out of me and planned to cite it publicly. I kept the original because professional embarrassment improves when it has witnesses. He called the first version unnecessarily cautious. He would have found the second version equally cautious if his name had appeared on the liability rather than the donor plaque.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Sue Venir

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I spent 6:39 to 6:45 on the fixed legal-office line dictating clause nine to outside counsel. We were putting the title objection back into the agreement. I asked them to countersign the original. Grant had already threatened my reputation; I preferred a second signature before he began distributing the blame.

IF MURDERER

I left a message for outside counsel and returned to the gallery desk to edit clause nine. Both legal opinions were in my folder. Grant expected a signature before his toast; I was deciding which objection he would have to read beneath it. Accuracy becomes particularly useful when the donor asks one to hurry.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Sue Venir

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Both opinions bear my signature. I cleaned the coffee ring from the original, then restored its title objection in clause nine. The margin handwriting is mine. It describes an ownership defect. The compromise draft could embarrass my firm; destroying the original would have made that embarrassment deserve rather more severe language.

IF MURDERER

Both opinions bear my signature, and I crossed out Grant's preferred title wording in the later agreement. I had promised him a final version before the toast. The compromise draft could damage my firm; the original could damage his claim. I retained them both. He was offering to make that an expensive decision.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACCUSATIONS



Sue Venir

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I signed the diluted opinion and kept the original. The countersigned clause-nine conference places me at the fixed legal-office microphone through the contamination interval. I will defend the original in public now. The quiet compromise was my failure. The poisoning was not.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

Outside counsel received my message, not six minutes of my presence. I took the preparation key, the reference toxin and the cloth to Grant's coupe. I meant to stop him announcing a title I knew was defective under my name. I have spent the evening choosing accurate words for an act I cannot defend.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.